

Chemical Engineering Meeting

April 25th, 2017

Attendees

1. Vikas Berry
2. Said Al-Hallaj
3. Betul Bilgin
4. Michael Caracotsios
5. Brian Chaplin
6. Gang Cheng
7. Sultana Ferdous
8. Sangil Kim
9. Ying Liu
10. Shafigh Mehraeen
11. Ludwig Nitsche
12. Vivek Sharma
13. Lewis Wedgewood
14. Sanjay Behura
15. Sarai Chavez

Minutes Approval

- Expand the discussion of computational environment for undergraduates (sophomore-senior)
- Minutes passed

Department Updates

- Welcome to Sarai Chavez (Office Support)
- College Awards (from last year)
 - Low Wedgewood “Best Teacher”
 - Sultana Ferdous “Best Advisor”
- Building Update: 780 sq. lab space, 180 sq. ft. student space; 17 total labs with combination of 3 & 2 hoods and 2 & 1 hoods; College has kept 3 labs to give out based on enrollment; 5 MIE labs; Service yard and wind tunnel belong to Civil engineering; need to isolate vibrations coming from civil engineering labs (wind tunnel, earthquake simulations, etc.); Nest meeting May 10 will have a 3 D model of labs.; Expected to Break ground in August or September
- ChemE Forum: Improvements would be to send timely announcements and invitations to alumni/mentors/sponsors; safety talk should be harvested for a class; good to have it in the building so alumni can enjoy and reminisce and for mentors/sponsors to see labs and classrooms

- Building Concern: only one conference room and seminar room, but they are larger; TA office absorbed into computer room which will have 40 seats; TA office will be moved next to the staircase on the 2nd level; Classrooms are on the 1st level
- Building Concern: Larger computer room needed for exams with appropriate software; laptops are an option but need too much maintenance; would need about 50-60 seats
- Is 205 a prerequisite for 300 level courses? Agreed that it should be and can be co-registered for certain courses
- China Update: 7 passed this year plus the 6 from last year; 2 applicants did not pass the English exam; In conversation to add 7 more universities and get them under contract
- Women in Science: Elsa Soto, Vivek, Shafigh and Vikas met to discuss summer program; Chemical and Electrical Engineering will be handling the program this summer; Elsa would like Deisy, another graduate student, and 3 or 4 undergraduate students; The program should be student led, no faculty, they want the high school students to not feel at school
- Molecular Engineering: No Updates

Report from DUGS Office

- 51 accepted offers: 28 freshmen and 23 transfers
- Last year was 27 freshmen and 20 transfers
- College of Engineering event to drum up interest “Ignite” on 4/8/17
- Phone call campaign to the undecided (Alan, Vikas, Karen, & Sarai)
- Two emails sent out to 300 undecided students.
- ABET Survey link sent out
- Incoming students are not checking emails. Need to remind freshmen to check their emails

Report from DGS Office (Wedgewood)

- About 200 applied, 160 completed the application
- 74 MS – 17 have accepted
- 30 PhD – 15 accepted, 10 are TAs
- Aiming to have 11-12 TAs
- 1 TA backed out because they believed the stipend was not enough to live in Chicago. Waiting to give out last positions
- 2 TAs are Iranian, there is an uncertainty due to the travel bans
- 1 PhD transferred to MS program
- 9 declines from the 74 MS
- 3 + 2 Students come in under the MS program
- Shore light recruitment agency has contracts around the world; Dr. Berry would like to contract them to bring in Graduate Students

Update on Seminars (Sharma/Chaplin)

- Satish is overbooked
- Emily Carter is going to try to get her next year
- Waiting on Sharon's reply
- Sharma will send out updated list in email
- Host should appoint graduate student or themselves to usher the guest around to meetings, or have the next person on the schedule retrieve the speaker from the current meeting.
 - May be a bit harsh on the student to have them interrupt a professor
 - Faculty should negotiate the best method for them
- Give a buffer moment for the speaker to relax with a coffee break at 2 or 3 p.m.
- If you invite the speaker, you make the schedule
 - Put one of the people from lunch as the post-lunch meeting (so they're more relaxed at lunch)

Safety (Chaplin)

- Dr. Kenis (Seminar speaker 4/20/17 & UIUC Head of Chemical and Biomolecular Engineering at UIUC) visited labs during his visit and was concerned that students were **not** wearing safety glasses or lab coats.
- Dr. Kenis visited Unit Ops and saw that students and the instructor were not wearing any safety gear.
- Need to enforce safety policy with students, everyone needs to take the safety course
- The first thing anyone does upon entering a lab is to take the online Safety Certification course to be able to work. A hard copy should be filed in an easily accessible spot and an electronic copy on a shared drive. (Chaplin has the link to the online course)
- Every lab should have an easily accessible drawer with all the certificates
- There should be 1 safety seminar every year; For grad students it should become a part of their orientation so that it sets a precedent. The safety policy articulated on the website
- Undergraduates: there needs to be repercussions or get out.
- First thing upon entering a lab is to put on safety gear, the PI should lead by example
- Be vigilant and enforce the policy, check the safety equipment (regularly flush out the shower and eye wash)
- Get a graduate student enforcer in your lab
- Set safety policy up as a part of your syllabus

WISEST (Liu)

- Successful event last week but no female representation from Chemical Engineering

COE-Executive Committee (Liu)

- Meeting got rescheduled for a later date. No updates

Old/Business/New Business

- Idea of a Qualifier- quick meeting in June if needed